

■ HACK2HUSTLE

Hackathon × Shark Tank

Build • Pitch • Innovate

OFFICIAL RULE BOOK

Theme: Technology for Quality, Inclusive & Accessible Education

SDG: SDG 4 – Quality Education

1. About the Event

- **Hack2Hustle** is a technology-based innovation challenge that combines the problem-solving and prototyping of a Hackathon with the business pitching format of Shark Tank.
- Participants will identify a real-world problem, develop a technology-driven solution, create a working prototype/MVP, and pitch their idea to a panel of judges.

2. Team Formation

- Each team must consist of **2–3 members**.
- Every team must have a unique team name.
- A participant can belong to only one team.
- Each team must select one problem statement/track.
- All members are expected to contribute to the project.
- Team changes after registration require approval from the organizing committee.

3. Challenge Tracks

- **Track 1 – AI & Smart Education:** Use AI or emerging technologies to improve learning and teaching.
- **Track 2 – Inclusive & Accessible Education:** Develop solutions that make education accessible to learners with different needs.
- **Track 3 – Education for All:** Address barriers such as language, affordability, connectivity or lack of resources.
- **Track 4 – Interactive & Engaging Learning:** Use gamification or innovative technology to make learning more engaging.
- **Track 5 – Future-Ready Education:** Solutions that help students develop skills, discover opportunities and prepare for the future.

4. Hackathon Phase

- Teams will follow: **Identify → Ideate → Build → Test → Pitch**.
- The final solution should address a real and clearly defined problem.
- Teams are encouraged to build an **MVP (Minimum Viable Product)** rather than attempting to create a complete commercial product.
- **Acceptable prototypes:** Website, mobile application, AI tool/chatbot, interactive prototype, software application, hardware + software solution, no-code/low-code prototype, or proof of concept.

5. Use of AI & External Tools

- AI tools are permitted for brainstorming, coding assistance, UI/UX design, content generation, data analysis and prototype development.
- Teams must understand the technology they present.
- The use of AI must be disclosed when asked by the judges.
- Copying an existing project and presenting it as original work is prohibited.
- Teams may be questioned about their implementation.

6. Shark Tank Pitch Round

- Each team will present its solution to the judging panel.
- Each team will receive **3 minutes** for its pitch.
- The presentation must clearly explain: **Problem Statement, Target Users, Proposed Solution, Prototype/Demonstration, Unique Selling Point (USP), SDG 4 Impact, Business/Market Potential, and Future Scope.**
- The prototype demonstration must be completed within the allotted 3 minutes.
- Teams are expected to present their idea confidently and professionally.
- The judges will evaluate teams based on the official 100-mark judging criteria.

7. Disqualification

- A team may be disqualified for plagiarism or substantial copying; presenting another person's project as its own; cheating or unfair practices; unauthorized access to systems or data; deliberately disrupting another team; misconduct; or violation of event rules.

8. Data & Ethics

- Teams must use dummy/sample data wherever possible.
- Teams must respect user privacy and avoid collecting unnecessary personal information.
- Major external resources/APIs used should be disclosed where applicable.
- Solutions should not intentionally discriminate against users.

9. Final Submission

- Team Name; Team Members; Selected Track; Problem Statement; Solution Description; Prototype/MVP; Technology Used; SDG 4 Impact; USP; Business Model; Future Scope.

10. Schedule

- 9:00 – 9:15** | Registration & Team Formation
- 9:15 – 9:30** | Inauguration & SDG 4 Briefing
- 9:30 – 9:45** | Hackathon Challenge & Rules
- 9:45 – 10:15** | Problem Identification & Ideation
- 10:15 – 12:15** | Build Your Prototype
- 12:15 – 13:15** | Lunch Break
- 13:15 – 15:15** | Testing & Final Preparation
- 15:15 – 16:15** | Team Presentations & Demo
- 16:20 – 16:45** | Evaluation & Awards

11. General Rules

- Participants must follow the instructions of the organizing committee.
- Teams must maintain professional conduct throughout the event.
- All deadlines must be strictly followed.
- Equipment and venue resources must be handled responsibly.
- The organizing committee reserves the right to make necessary decisions regarding unforeseen situations.
- **The decision of the judges will be final and binding.**

■ **HACK2HUSTLE**

“Don’t just build an idea. Build something worth investing in.”

Think. Hack. Build. Pitch. Defend. Win.